MANUAL · HOW TO USE IT

Travel Buddy

Trip planner, logbook and companion for the road trip through Western Australia, on the Mac and on the iPhone, even without signal.

Basic version · as of 29 October 2026

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In short: plan on the Mac, set up the iPhone once with internet, use the iPhone on the road. Syncing works with a backup file that is merged when you import it. Nothing ends up on someone else's server, there is no account and no advertising.

The first time you open it a short introduction walks you through the app: set the trip start, learn the terms leg, calendar and logbook, create your first stage, paste a booking, load documents onto the device, discover places. You can skip any step. **More →** 🧭 **Show the introduction again** starts it once more.

PART 1

Getting started

1 · On the Mac

1. Open the address of the app you were given in Safari or Chrome.
2. The introduction starts by itself. After that everything is stored in this browser. Right at the start you can download the maps with “Small” or “Large”.

On the iPhone

1. Open the address of the app in **Safari**.
2. Tap **Share**, then “Add to Home Screen” and “Add”. The “TravelBuddy” icon appears.
3. Open the app from the home screen once with internet. After that it also starts in flight mode.

> **Safari and the home screen have separate storage.** What you enter in the Safari tab isn't visible in the home screen app and vice versa. On the road, only use the app from the home screen. iOS doesn't delete its data by itself.

JUST PLAY FIRST: THE TEST TRIP

“🧪 Play with a test trip first” in the introduction, or More → Test trip, fills the app with a made-up 21-day trip that is always in progress: today is day 10, nine days are in the logbook, the next flight leaves in 20 hours. Flight and warning data are invented and nothing is looked up. Your own data is set aside in the meantime. **End test trip** clears everything and brings it back unchanged. Whatever you changed in the test trip is then gone.

NEW VERSION

When a new version has been uploaded, the app loads it by itself the next time you open it with internet. Your entries stay. Which version is running is shown at the very bottom in the footer, for example “Basic · Build 1/5/2027, 9:29 pm”.

PART 2

Layout and controls

2 · Five sections

SECTION	WHAT'S THERE
Today	Countdown or travel day, the drive of the day, cockpit, facts and figures, costs, the globe
Plan	Legs and routes, hikes, offline map, calendar
Places	144 places in the South, North and East Coast, My places, route ideas
Logbook	Entries, reading the journal and creating a file, wildlife, notes
More	Emergency, trip preparation, flights & trains, costs, hazards, packing list, tips, music, share travel report, quiz, plus backup, import, manual, theme and language

IPHONE

- At the bottom the floating bar with the five sections, with the round **search button** next to it on the right.
- "More" opens a sheet from the bottom. To close it, tap next to it or swipe down.
- At the top, below the title, the sub-pages of the section as a swipeable bar.
- Back: swipe from the left edge.

MAC (FROM 900 PIXELS WIDE)

- On the left a sidebar with the same sections and their sub-pages, at the bottom backup, import, manual, theme (auto, light, dark) and language.
- Search with `⌘K` or `/`. Back works with the browser's back button.

LANGUAGE

German or English, by default the device language. Switch at the bottom of the sidebar (Mac) or under "🌐 Language" in the More sheet (iPhone).

Search

Searches places, days, animals, hikes, bookings, legs, notes and lists. A date like `3/12` or `Day 5` shows that day. Below the search field, the labels **MUST-SEE**, **HIDDEN GEM**, **4WD ONLY**, **EXPEDITION** and **MY PLACE** filter the list. A result jumps to its tile and briefly highlights it. On the iPhone the search field sits at the bottom above the keyboard. At the bottom of the sheet you set the date for the sun times of all places.

The app asks before anything is deleted (red button). After an import, "Undo" reverses the change.

PART 3

Today

3 · What “Today” shows

WHEN	CONTENT
Before the trip	Days until departure, the next three bookings, how far your trip preparation is
On the road	“Day N of M”, the leg, what's booked today and tomorrow, the **drive of the day** and the button “Write today's logbook entry”
Afterwards	Days on the road, how many of them are in the logbook, the way to the journal

DRIVE OF THE DAY

If there's a drive today, one line shows the distance, the driving time including breaks and the **latest departure** to arrive before sunset. At dusk there's a lot of wildlife on Australian roads. If it gets too tight, the line warns you and suggests splitting the drive over several days, with exact sections.

COCKPIT, FACTS AND FIGURES

- Quiz level and, from the first logbook day, travel days, km, temperature, flies, kangaroos and roadkill.
- Km driven and flown, fuel and fuel costs (estimated at 13 litres per 100 km), hours at the wheel, comparisons.

COSTS AND BUDGET

Enter a budget in euros. The app adds up the costs from the logbook and the advance costs and shows everything in euros and AU$, converted at each day's rate. Without signal it uses an approximate rate and says so. All the amounts shown add up exactly to the total shown.

MY TRIP MAP

- A globe with all legs and routes. Two fingers turn it, one finger scrolls the page.
- **“Play trip”** flies to the legs one after the other. **“🎬 Film”** records a portrait video from it, with up to three photos per leg, to share or save.
- Tap a route: an info window with km, driving time, photos and logbook. “To the trip” jumps into the plan.
- If the device is too slow for the globe, the map switches to flat by itself. The 🗺️ /🌍 button switches by hand.

PART 4

Plan

4 · Legs and routes

> **Leg** = a period of time with fixed dates, for example “Road trip Western Australia, 13 Dec to 27 Jan”. Most of them come from your travel calendar.
>
> **Route** = a way with stops within a leg, for example “Coral Coast: Perth → Exmouth”. A route doesn't make the trip longer.

- **Legs**: a list with dates, km, routes, hikes, bookings and how many days are in the logbook. The app points out gaps and overlaps.
- Tap a leg: name, colour, dates, bookings with 📎 vouchers, routes, hikes, logbook.
- **“+ New”** adds a leg, route, hike or logbook day, with only the fields you really need.

EDITING A ROUTE

1. Expand the route, choose 🚗 car, ✈️ flight or 🚆 train at the top. For flights and trains the app asks right away for number, date, booking, seat and document.
2. “Add stop” searches all places and WA towns. A new stop goes where it makes the smallest detour.
3. Drag the handle ≡ to change the order. Tapping a stop shows its photo and “remove”.
4. “📍 Open in Google Maps” hands the route over for navigation (up to 11 stops).

Every stop shows “x km from …”. All sections together add up exactly to the km at the top of the route.

PLANNING IN A PLACE FROM YOUR COLLECTION

On a place tile, “+ Plan in”: the app offers your routes by proximity, with the distance from the route, plus “New route with this place” and “Save as hike”.

PART 5

What the app works out for a route

5 · Road route and straight line

The real road route comes online (OSRM service): km, driving time and the way itself. **Without signal, stops can still be added** and the app estimates the route straight away from the straight-line distance, then fits it to the real road as soon as there is signal. Open each route once with internet, then km and hints are saved. “Ready for the road?” shows which routes are still missing.

HINT	WHAT IT SAYS
⛽ **Fuel stations**	The longest stretch without a fuel station and every long stretch with the last and next fuel station by name. Red if it's longer than your range (adjustable, default 500 km).
Supplies on the road	Fuel stations, water, toilets, camps, rest areas, shops, mechanics and clinics along the route with their route km, by section. Long stretches without fuel or water in red. Offline from OpenStreetMap.
Driving days	For each driving day the km, driving time with breaks and the latest departure before sunset. Days that are too long come with a suggestion for splitting them.
Worth seeing	Places from your collection up to 25 km from the route, plan them in at the right point with “+” or hide them.
🌦 **Weather**	Forecast along the route for the next three days (needs signal).
Warnings	Official warnings within the set radius around the route.

HOW THE NUMBERS FIT TOGETHER

- All route km of a route are calibrated to its length according to the road route. The destination is exactly at the km at the top.
- Each position is rounded once to whole km, lengths are the difference. “from km 528 to 826” therefore means exactly 298 km.
- The fuel hint and the supplies always show the same number, because they come from the same calculation.

Fuel stations count up to 5 km from the route, everything else up to 3 km. Check opening hours and whether the water is drinkable on site.

PART 6

Map, hikes, calendar

6 · Offline map (Plan → Map)

- One map for all of Australia. When you zoom in it loads the more detailed map area by itself: west coast, east coast, Melbourne, Cairns, Whitsundays.
- "📥 **Save all of Australia**" puts all map areas on the device (about 80 MB). Tap it once on Wi-Fi and wait.
- The "Show" bar: places, ⛽ fuel stations, 💧 water, 🅿️ rest areas, 🏕️ camping, 🚻 toilets, 🛒 shops, 🔧 mechanics, 🏥 clinics, with the number in view. Tap a point: name, coordinates, Google Maps or Apple Maps.
- **Warning areas** sit on the map as shapes, with radius and your position. The button on the map shows or hides them.
- 🚜 **Large map** (large package only): shows every road and track in Western Australia. On the web it stays off until you turn it on. Then the app downloads the part you are in as you zoom in, 33 to 76 MB each. Turning it off frees the storage again.
- The terrain shading is only available online.

Hikes

Wish list, planned or done. Date and time, starting point with navigation, length, duration, elevation gain, water, difficulty, rating and photos. Hikes with a date appear in the logbook on the right day.

Calendar

At the top you switch between **List**, **Month** and **Year**. The year shows all legs in colour at a glance, tap a month to open it and tap a day to see its events. The app remembers your view.

"My overall plan" with all legs, bookings and hikes. **Export as PDF** creates a file to save and share, 📊 **Excel** a spreadsheet with one row per event. Below it the original suggestion for reference.

PART 7

Places

7 · The place tile

- Photo, labels, description and what applies there in December and January (season).
- **Sun and weather**: sunrise and sunset, blue and golden hour, weather (online) and the **night sky**: moon, darkness, Milky Way.
- A warning badge when an official warning affects the place.
- 📷 in the bottom right corner of the photo changes the picture: choose one from your device, open the image search or paste a snippet. Your picture stays on the device. ✨ appears in the same spot where a stand-in or sample picture is shown.
- **On iPhone** a picture in the Google search often cannot be saved because it is only online. Take a screenshot, crop it and pick it with "Choose picture from device".
- 💬 opens your note, photos and the logbook days for this place.

ADDING A PLACE

"+ Add place" (in South, North, East Coast and My places) first asks which place you mean: as you type, suggestions from OpenStreetMap appear with their type and state, for example "Margaret River · Town · Western Australia". If the place is already in the app, it's shown at the top. Without signal you add it by hand.

Then you check and adjust: name, icon, description, coordinates, labels and group. The app fetches the photo and description from Wikipedia and picks the **group** (South, North, East Coast with region) by the nearest stored place. Sun times, stars, weather and hazards come from the coordinates, just like for every other place. The place then appears in its group and under "My places".

PART 8

Logbook and journal

8 · Days

Every travel day is a dot on the coloured band of its leg: filled = written, ring = still open, small = still to come. Today is larger and is jumped to when you open it.

WRITING A DAY

1. “Write today's logbook entry” on Today, or “+ Day” in the logbook.
2. Choose the place or route of the day, then the text.
3. Add photos, a 🎙 voice note, quick stats (km, weather, flies, signal, mood, road trains) and 16 topics from costs to the night sky. Under “Costs & transport” you add as many single expenses as you like.

Didn't write every day? “To (several days)” or “Add several days” on the leg and in the logbook adds one entry for the whole period. Its expenses count once.

SORTING PHOTOS

Choose several photos at once. The app reads the date and location from the image data and puts each photo on the right day, in an existing or a new entry.

Wildlife

A collector's album with 20 animals. Add a sighting with number, date, place and photo, also directly in the day's entry.

Read: the journal

- A chapter per leg with a globe, routes, places and hikes. You choose at the top what's shown.
- 📊 **Summary**: travel days, days written, km, costs, animals.
- 🖨 **Print as journal or PDF** and ✨ **Collage** as a slideshow of your photos.

My location

The location button at the bottom right of the map jumps to you, also offline. The dot follows you while the map is open. The radius under Hazards applies to you, your places and your routes.

Photo conditions

On the home screen, photo conditions show the rating, best time, clouds and moon in one line. Opened up, you get golden and blue hour, moon, Milky Way with time and direction, star trails, sky and camera starting points. Sun, moon and stars work offline, clouds, visibility and wind need signal. City light is a rough estimate.

Temperature on the edge

When you open the app, the temperature where you are glows briefly on the right edge. The higher the number sits, the warmer it is. It needs signal and your location, and you can turn it off under More → Design.

Design

More → Design brings together light and dark, language, text, size and the effects: soft fade, connection glow and weather mood. You can switch each effect off on its own or all at once.

Notes

Categories notes, shopping, route tips, admin and contacts with the buttons at the top, to tick off and to export as a text file. In the field beside them you choose the leg, and every note has its time stamp. Notes appear in the logbook by themselves, take them out there with ✕, and 📖 brings them back.

PART 9

More

9 · 🆘 Emergency (completely offline)

> **Real emergency: call 000 first.** 112 works on any mobile network, 106 is the emergency SMS service, the Royal Flying Doctors are on 1800 625 800. Without mobile coverage only a satellite device helps.

Your location to read out and copy, the nearest fuel station, water point, clinic and mechanic with direction, plus “Share location” and “✅ I'm OK”.

💼 Trip preparation

- Checklist “Weeks before”, “Shortly before”, “Departure day” with your own items.
- Documents with expiry dates, bookings with vouchers (part 10), advance costs.
- **“+ From email”**: paste the text of a booking email. Type, title, date, time, place, booking number and price are recognised. You check and import it.
- **“Ready for the road?”** checks five points: offline maps, app and supply points offline, routes calculated, Spotify connected, last backup.

⚠️ Hazards

Official warnings from WA, Victoria and Queensland for fire, flood and severe weather within the set radius around your places, plus the **WA road conditions** (closures from Main Roads, split into “on your route” and “nearby”). Without signal the last status stays visible. The weather hints below are derived, not official warnings.

The app checks your position, the road ahead, every leg and every hike. Each warning shows the size of the area and the distance, plus buttons for Google Maps and the offline map with radius and your position. **Test mode** shows all of this with a position of your choice and made-up warnings.

✈️ Flights & trains

All flights and trains of the trip with status, new times, terminal, gate, check-in desk, platform, baggage belt and connections. Add them under route, leg or pre-trip costs. Every entry with a number is checked by itself, more often as departure gets closer. 24 hours before, a notice appears on Today.

Flights need your own free RapidAPI key (AeroDataBox, Basic plan). It stays on the device and is not part of the backup, and the app shows your quota. German trains need no key, and the departure board looks about 3 hours ahead.

💰 Costs

Everything from pre-trip costs and the logbook: short values, long values, transport, stays and experiences, per leg and under “Analyse items” down to the single expense. Long values stay out of the daily average. Every list adds up exactly to the total.

🎒 Packing list · 🛠️ Tips · 📤 Share · 🇦🇺 Quiz

A packing list for the outback to tick off, print and export as a spreadsheet. Tips on permits, fuel and tyres. **Share travel report** makes a single file for family and friends with legs, routes, places and the photos you choose, without bookings, costs, documents, contacts and exact coordinates. The quiz has 50 questions in five levels.

🎵 Music on the road

Collects local music in a Spotify playlist of your own as you travel: bands from the area (MusicBrainz), your favourite styles first, with your own Last.fm key also charts. Needs **Spotify Premium** and your own free Spotify app on developer.spotify.com: enter the redirect address shown under More → Music there, copy the client ID into the app and “Connect to Spotify” once. Music is only collected while the app is open and “turned on”, in developer mode for at most five accounts.

PART 10

Getting vouchers and documents onto the device

> **The vouchers are not online.** Tickets, hotel confirmations, passport and visa carry names and booking numbers. That's why the uploaded app contains not a single voucher. You put them onto each device once yourself.

1. Open the app with internet: expand **More → Trip preparation →** 🎟 **Bookings**.
2. **"📂 Choose PDFs"** → open the folder with your vouchers in the Files app → "Select" at the top → all → "Open". Photos of tickets go through "Photos". On the Mac, "whole folder" also works.
3. The app suggests the matching appointment for each file. Confirm it or pick one yourself, including " Own documents" for passport and visa.

After that every 📎 on a booking opens its PDF, even offline. Passport, visa, driver's licence and insurance appear in green under **Own documents**.

- A ticket that only exists as a photo or screenshot: **"🖼 Photo of a ticket"** → choose or take the photo → in the list pick the booking under "Belongs to" → save. The same goes for any file the app doesn't recognise by itself.
- The vouchers do **not** go into the backup. After a new device or deleting the app, simply choose the folder again.
- "delete" removes all vouchers from this device again. The files in iCloud stay.
- 🔒 **Protect vouchers:** "Protect with Face ID" (Mac: Touch ID) shows an **emergency code**. Write it on paper, type it in, confirm with Face ID. From then on the vouchers are stored encrypted and only open after Face ID or with the code, offline too. Once unlocked they stay open for five minutes. Set it up once on the iPhone and once on the Mac.

PART 11

Backing up and syncing

11 · Backup and import

- 💾 **Backup** saves a file `WA-Reiseplan-Backup_YYYY-MM-DD.json` and opens the share menu (AirDrop, mail).
- 📂 **Import** first shows a preview and **merges**: new things are added, additions are taken over, nothing on this device is deleted. Afterwards "Undo" works.
- Entries you deliberately deleted are passed on too. An empty field never overwrites a filled one.
- The import recognises a file from the calendar app by itself and builds the legs and bookings from it.

Mac and iPhone don't sync automatically. The way: backup on one device, send it via AirDrop, import on the other. If you change the order of stops on the same route on both devices, sync first. Vouchers and music data are not in the backup.

PART 12

Offline in the outback

12 · What works without signal

WORKS OFFLINE

- All your data, plan, logbook, journal
- Saved routes with km and hints
- Adding stops (the route is estimated straight away)
- Offline map (saved areas)
- Supplies along the route, driving days
- Sun times, night sky
- Emergency, packing list, quiz
- Vouchers stored on the device
- Last status of the hazards, flights and trains
- Warning areas on the offline map, costs

NEEDS SIGNAL

- The real road route (until then an estimate)
- Weather and weather along the route
- New warnings and road conditions
- New status for flights and trains
- Daily exchange rate (otherwise approximate)
- Suggestions, photo and details for new places
- Terrain shading, map on the globe
- Music on the road

Before you leave

1. Get the new version onto the iPhone (open the app once with internet).
2. Import the latest backup from the Mac.
3. Load and assign the vouchers.
4. Plan → Map → “Save all of Australia”.
5. Open each route once with signal until the km and hints appear.
6. “Ready for the road?” shows five of five points.
7. **Flight mode test**: open the app, tap a voucher, zoom in on the map.

PART 13

When something goes wrong

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
Old version	Close the app and open it again with internet. If that doesn't help: add `/reset.html` to the app's address, open it and press the button. The red button also deletes maps and vouchers.
Data missing	Is the Safari tab running instead of the home screen app? They have separate storage. On the Mac: is it the same browser you set it up in?
Route only a straight line	Open the route with signal or tap "🔄 Recalculate".
"x of 6 map areas"	On Wi-Fi, tap "Save all of Australia" and wait until everything has loaded.
📎 **opens nothing**	The vouchers aren't on this device yet: part 10.
Print or PDF doesn't start	Allow pop-ups for the app.
Spotify isn't collecting	More → Music: connected? "turned on"? Signal? "Catch up now" fetches waiting places.
Wrong language	Switch it at the bottom of the sidebar (Mac) or in the More sheet (iPhone).

Three little extras

Type `sn4ke`, `xoxo` or `4444` into the search field.